

A SILENT SONG

GUIDE BOOK

VOLUME 1

A SERIES OF KCSE PREDICTION QUESTIONS

PREPARED BY KNEC EXAMINERS ©

FOR MARKING SCHEMES,

CONTACT

Mr Machuki 0724 333 200/ 0795 491 185

kenyaeducators@gmail.com

KENYA EDUCATORS CONSULTANCY



A SILENT SONG COMPLETE GUIDE FOR HIGH SCHOOLS



About the book:

Education is a key for a country's development, but it becomes a hindrance when it is unequally distributed. This big problem of disparity in Education system can be solved through technology. Hence it's high time we embrace technology in Education sooner than later.

Teachers will therefore use the book in their laptops to teach and even give students notes to read online after revision.



A study guide to a silent song and other stories

A MAN OF AWESOME POWERS (Naguib Mahfouz-Egypt) Points to guide interpretation

- ❏ How Tayyib acquires his power. □ Use of power by Tayyib:
 - o For selfish interests
 - o For the good of all
 - o To harm others
- ❏ How power changes Tayyib.
- ❏ The role of the media
- ❏ What causes Tayyib to lose his incredible power?

SYNOPSIS

A Man of Awesome Power is an intriguing story about Tayyib al-Mahdi, who lives a comfortable life after retiring from many years of service abroad. His current life is peaceful and uneventful. He spends time watching television, reading newspapers or listening to the radio in the comfort of his apartment that he shares with his wife since his daughters are already married. The story captures how an individual who is empowered when least expected utilises the power given to him. His illusions of desire for a better country lead to his dream of power acquisition.

One night, Tayyib dreams of a visitation by a man of radiant appearance who speaks to him in a kind tone, informing him that God had willed him the power to order things to be and they would be. Although he dismisses the dream like any other dream, its frequent recurrence makes him give it more thought. Tayyib confirms its reality when he orders his television to switch channels, and it happens. Endowed with the newly acquired power, he sets out to reform his country and the entire planet as he had often wished.

He utilises his power both for good and bad intentions. He starts by hitting back a taxi driver who ignores him by wishing him an accident. He also causes a man who had physically attacked a woman in a bus to suffer stomach cramps. We see him engaging in meritorious deeds such as filling a gaping pothole, locking an electric box and removing a pile of rubbish that he trips on.

The media does not escape his wrath as he causes one radio announcer to suffer massive sneezes after making an announcement that gave false hopes. As the story progresses, Sulayman Bey al-Hamalawi, a political leader who had evaded tax, is ordered by Tayyib to go and pay the tax that he had been avoiding for a long time.



An unfortunate incident occurs when Tayyib is busy planning to effectively utilise his power for the good of all sectors in the country. He notices a beautiful woman at the entrance of the tea garden and uses his ability to satisfy his desires for her. Their intimacy costs him his incredible power. He pays this price for misusing the power that God had freely given him. The story ends with his sad realisation that he no longer has power. His attempts to order the television channels to change do not bear fruits. He experiences a tremendous sadness that will haunt him for the rest of his life.

CHARACTERS a. Tayyib al-Mahdi

❧ He is the main character in the story, and the story revolves around the awesome power that he miraculously acquires sometime after his retirement. □ He does not reveal to his wife that he had been bestowed with such power. His initial intention is to use the ability to change his country and the entire planet like he had always wished.

❧ He is portrayed as religious, ambitious yet emotional and vengeful.

EPISODIC ANALYSIS OF KEY ISSUES

'Man of Awesome Power' is founded on several pillars determined by the various episodes:

1. Tayyib's dream — pg 1-2
2. Utilising the awesome power -pg 2-4
3. Losing the awesome power- pg 5

Nide to a silent son and other stories

Some key issues arise from the episodes:

Acquisition of power

How Tayyib acquires his power teaches several things:

One can gain power at any stage of life.

Tayyib believed that he had completed his mission in the world. Before acquiring power, he lives a peaceful life as he enjoys the fruits of retirement. The writer notes that 'He had generous insurance and more than adequate pension' pg 1 which do not prevent him from being given power by God.

Power is God-given.



Tayyib's power is bestowed on him by God. As seen from his words, "All praise to God, Lord of the Worlds", and listening to radio channels devoted to the Quran (pg 1), his religious nature is one reason God willed to grant him power. The man who visits him in the dream tells him that starting that moment and as long as God willed, he had been bestowed with the power to order things to be and they would be. (pg 1)

Utilisation of Power

Tayyib utilises the power given to him in different incidents:

Encounter with the taxi driver (pg 2)

In the bus, to deal with the conflict between a man and a woman (pg 3).

Performing memorable services along his way to the cafe (pg 3).

The radio announcer (pg 3).

Tayyib's wrath on Sulayman Bey al-Hamalawi (pg 3-4). ✓ The beautiful woman in the Tea Garden (pg 4).

Good utilisation of power

The episode shows how a person bestowed with power should utilise it. Tayyib's soliloquy during his encounter with the taxi driver captures the need to use power for the well-being of others and to make things better. 'Whoever is granted with power like mine, must utilise it only for good.' (pg 2)

For Complete Setbook guides and Similar
Resources:

Order online at:

www.kenyaeducators.co.ke

or

Contact:

Mr Machuki – 0724333200
kenyaeducators@gmail.com

KENYA EDUCATORS CONSULTANCY

